CS 301R · MVP THINKING WORKSHOP

What Must V1 Prove?

Name _____

Project _____

An MVP is an instrument, not a small product. Its job is to test claims with something a real person can use. Answer each question for **your** first version, with the evidence you'd see on the progress demo, then rank the three claims (1 = the one v1 most needs to prove). A claim with no evidence line is a hope.

1 · The need claim

RANK

What shows a real user's need is actually served? Trace it to the success criteria in your product definition.

The claim

Evidence we'll see

2 · The technical claim

RANK

Which risk from your risk register does v1 retire? What could a working slice prove that a mockup couldn't?

The risk

Evidence we'll see

3 · The usability claim

RANK

Can the target user get through the slice unaided? Who will try it, and what counts as "unaided"?

Who tries it

Evidence we'll see

4 · The falsifier

If no possible result could tell you something's wrong, v1 proves nothing: sharpen a claim.

If we saw this…

…we'd know

5 · The cut *every project has one*

One thing we're building that proves none of these:

Moved to: ☐ the next milestone ☐ the roadmap ☐ dropped

6 · Throwaway corners *inside the part we're keeping*

What's mocked, hardcoded, or temporary in v1?

Labeled in: ☐ `docs/known-issues.md` ☐ the code ☐ issue

Share-out, aloud: our top claim is _____

and our cut is _____

This becomes your MVP Plan: the ranked claims are its demo plan, the cut and the corners go under "what's deferred." Keep this sheet; it's your working copy.